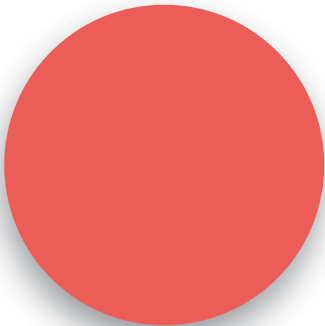
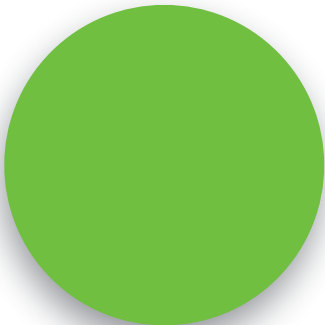


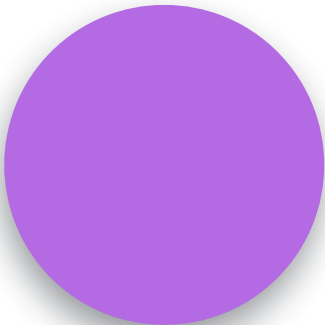


Henri Rousseau









Today we turn to our third big question: What are you?

Today we turn to our third big question. This question can be introduced by an

example.

Philosophy class decided to have an Intro to Philosophy reunion, and all gathered in

Suppose that in the year 2069 the surviving members of this Introduction to

this room. Suppose that they decided to get a group picture taken.

Now imagine that, via some sort of time travel device, I have that photo, and

show it to you. You might ask: Am I one of those people? Which one am I?

is you. And, if one is you, there must be some fact about which one is

But is every natural assumption that these questions must have determined answers?

you.

There must be some fact of the matter about whether or not the people in the photo

Let's suppose that this is true: there must be a fact about whether you survive to be



in this picture, and must be a fact about which the survivors are

Then we can ask a question about these facts:



To introduce our main answers to the survival question, it will be

useful to think about simple, universal example of survival.

the same point another way, all of you believe that the person now

sitting in your seat is the same person as — identical to — the person

All of you believe that you will wake up tomorrow in your bed. To put

who will wake up in your bed tomorrow.

What do we mean when we say that you are identical to that person?

Here it is important to get clear at the outset on one distinction which, if not

This is the distinction between numerical and qualitative identity.

attended to, can make these questions more confusing than they have to be.

Today that x and y are numerically identical is to say that they are literally the

same thing — they are one, not two.

To say that x and y things are qualitatively identical is to say that they

exactly resembling — they have just the same properties.

to morning, we are not of course saying that you are qualitatively

identical to that person. Their hair will be messed up, and they will be wearing

When we say that you are identical to the person who will get out of your bed

different identities.

Rather, we mean that you are numerically identical to that person: there is just

one person who is today in this class, and is tomorrow in that bed.

Let's look at some answers to the survival question.

the same person as the person who will wake up in that bed?

But then we can ask the survival question: in virtue of what are you numerical



But this is not the only answer to our question. It is a

widely held view that we are not simply material beings, but

also have innovative materials.

existence in material soul.

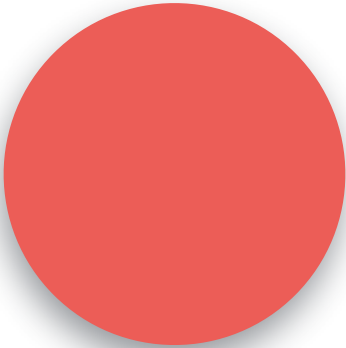
that one's survival is closely linked to the continued

If one believes in immaterial souls, then it is natural to think

the person who wakes up in that bed tomorrow is you

because they are, or have, the same immaterial soul.

This suggests an alternative theory of survival. On this view,



physical connections, and not be afraid of anything involving

But these are not the only possible views here. One might

also hold that you are that person not because of any

immaterial souls, but rather because psychological

connections between you and that person.

focus on memories. On this view, the thing which makes

you the same person as the person who will wake up in that

bedtime is your shared memories.

Which psychological connections? One popular approach

personalities.

connections you will have to that person as well. You will

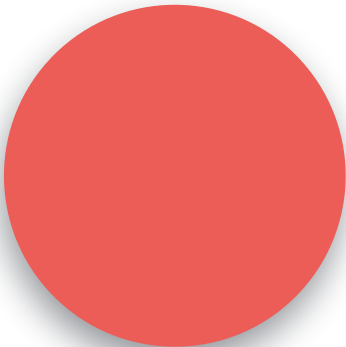
Of course there are plenty of other psychological

have very similar beliefs and desires, and very similar

Let's call the idea that you are the same person because of

psychological connections psychological survival.





Questions about what you are closely related to questions about survival. We can

introduce the kinds of questions about survival we will be focusing on with an example